

Validation System Documentation

This directory contains centralized, reusable validation schemas for the Gema backend API.

Structure

```
validators/
├── common.validator.ts    # Reusable validation helpers (MongoDB IDs, pagination, etc.)
├── auth.validator.ts      # Authentication-related validations
├── user.validator.ts      # User profile and account validations
├── event.validator.ts     # Event creation and management validations
├── order.validator.ts     # Order and booking validations
└── README.md             # This file
```

Usage Examples

Basic Usage in Routes

```
import { Router } from 'express';
import { validate } from '../middleware';
import { validateRegistration, validateLogin } from '../validators/auth.validator';
import * as authController from '../controllers/auth.controller';

const router = Router();

// Before: Inline validation (verbose, repetitive)
router.post('/register', [
  body('email').trim().notEmpty().isEmail(),
  body('password').notEmpty().isLength({ min: 8 }),
  // ... many more lines
], validate, authController.register);

// After: Centralized validation (clean, reusable)
router.post('/register', validateRegistration, validate, authController.register);
router.post('/login', validateLogin, validate, authController.login);
```

Combining Multiple Validators

```
import { validateMongoId, validatePagination } from '../validators/common.validator';
import { validateEventSearch } from '../validators/event.validator';

// Combine common validators with specific ones
router.get(
  '/events/:id',
  validateMongoId('id', 'param'),
  validate,
  eventController.getEvent
);

// Combine multiple validator arrays
router.get(
  '/events',
  validateEventSearch, // Includes pagination, sorting, filtering
  validate,
  eventController.listEvents
);
```

Using Common Validators

The `common.validator.ts` file provides frequently-used validators:

```
import {
  validateMongoId,      // MongoDB ObjectId validation
  validatePagination,   // page, limit query params
  validateSort,         // sortBy, sortOrder query params
  validateDateRange,    // startDate, endDate query params
  validatePriceRange,   // minPrice, maxPrice query params
  validateSearch,       // search query param with XSS protection
  validateEmail,        // Email validation with normalization
  validatePhone,        // International phone number validation
  validateEnum,         // Enum/allowed values validation
} from '../validators/common.validator';

// Example: Event search endpoint
router.get('/events', [
  ...validatePagination,
  ...validateSort(['title', 'price', 'createdAt']),
  ...validateDateRange,
  ...validatePriceRange,
], validate, eventController.search);
```

Available Validators

Common Validators (common.validator.ts)

Validator	Parameters	Description
validateMongoId()	field, location	MongoDB ObjectId validation
validatePagination	-	page (min: 1), limit (1-100)
validateSort()	allowedFields	sortBy, sortOrder validation
validateDateRange	-	startDate, endDate with logic check
validatePriceRange	-	minPrice, maxPrice with logic check
validateSearch	-	Search query with XSS protection
validateEmail()	field, required	Email with normalization
validatePhone()	field, required	International phone format
validateUrl()	field, required	URL validation
validateArray()	field, min, max	Array length validation
validateStringLength()	field, min, max, required	String length validation
validateNumericRange()	field, min, max, required	Numeric range validation
validateEnum()	field, values, required	Enum validation
sanitizeHtml()	field	XSS protection for HTML
validateCoordinates	-	Latitude/longitude validation

Auth Validators (auth.validator.ts)

- validateRegistration - User registration
- validateLogin - User login
- validateRefreshToken - Token refresh
- validateChangePassword - Password change
- validateForgotPassword - Password reset request
- validateResetPassword - Password reset confirmation
- validateEmailVerification - Email OTP verification
- validateResendVerification - Resend verification email
- validateFirebaseAuth - Firebase authentication
- validate2FASetup - Two-factor auth setup
- validate2FAVerification - 2FA token verification

User Validators (user.validator.ts)

- validateProfileUpdate - Update user profile
- validateAddress - Add/update address
- validateAddressIndex - Validate address array index
- validateAvatarUpdate - Update avatar URL
- validateBusinessHours - Vendor business hours
- validateSocialMedia - Social media links
- validateVendorPaymentSettings - Vendor payment settings
- validateUserStatusUpdate - User status (admin)
- validateUserRoleUpdate - User role (admin)

Event Validators (`event.validator.ts`)

- `validateCreateEvent` - Create new event
- `validateUpdateEvent` - Update existing event
- `validateEventFAQ` - Event FAQs
- `validateEventSEO` - SEO metadata
- `validateEventSearch` - Event search/filtering
- `validateEventApproval` - Event approval (admin)

Order Validators (`order.validator.ts`)

- `validateCreateOrder` - Create new order
- `validateParticipants` - Participant information
- `validateUpdateOrderStatus` - Update order status
- `validateUpdatePaymentStatus` - Update payment status
- `validateRefundOrder` - Process refund
- `validateCheckIn` - Check-in for event
- `validateOrderSearch` - Order search/filtering

Benefits

1. **Code Reusability:** Define validation rules once, use everywhere
2. **Consistency:** Same validation logic across all endpoints
3. **Maintainability:** Update validation in one place
4. **Security:** Built-in XSS protection, input sanitization
5. **Type Safety:** TypeScript support for better autocomplete
6. **Cleaner Routes:** Reduced code from ~30 lines to 1 line per endpoint

Migration Guide

To migrate existing routes to use the new validation system:

1. Import the appropriate validators:

```
import { validateLogin } from '../validators/auth.validator';
```

2. Replace inline validation arrays:

```
// Before
router.post('/login', [body('email')...], validate, controller.login);

// After
router.post('/login', validateLogin, validate, controller.login);
```

3. Test the endpoint to ensure validation works correctly

Adding New Validators

When adding new validators:

1. Use existing validators in `common.validator.ts` as building blocks
2. Keep validators focused and reusable
3. Add JSDoc comments explaining parameters and usage
4. Export as named export for tree-shaking
5. Update this README with the new validator

Example:

```
/**
 * Validate coupon code
 */
export const validateCouponCode = [
  body('code')
    .trim()
    .notEmpty()
    .withMessage('Coupon code is required')
    .isLength({ min: 3, max: 20 })
    .withMessage('Coupon code must be between 3 and 20 characters')
    .isAlphanumeric()
    .withMessage('Coupon code must contain only letters and numbers')
    .toUpperCase(),
];
```

Security Features

All validators include:

- **XSS Protection:** `.escape()` for user input
- **SQL Injection Protection:** MongoDB parameterized queries
- **Input Sanitization:** `.trim()`, `.toLowerCase()` where appropriate
- **Type Coercion:** `.toInt()`, `.toFloat()`, `.toBoolean()` for type safety
- **Length Limits:** Prevent DoS attacks with max lengths
- **Enum Validation:** Whitelist-based validation for allowed values